BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Friday 23 Oct 2026, 07:50 Malaysia time (23:50 UTC Thu)

BTC ~ $81,300

CoinGecko: -3.4% 24h, -1.4% 7d

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral-bearish (risk-off macro, longs flushed)	**Next 24h:** $79,800 - $83,000 (base)	**Key floor:** $80,000 - $81,250 band, then $79,000	**Big event:** Weekly expiry today 4:00pm MYT; FOMC Thu 29 Oct 2:00am MYT

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

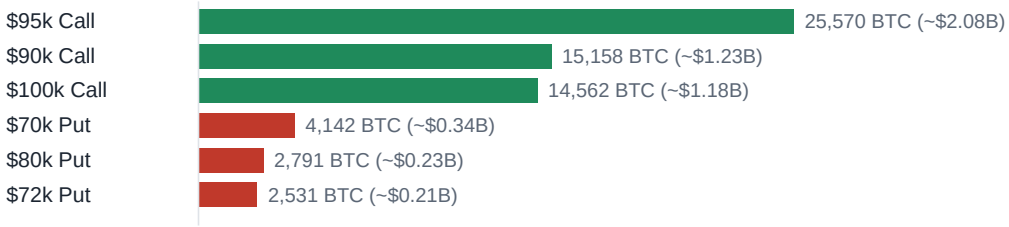
- **Next expiry:** today, Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm MYT (08:00 UTC). This is the daily and the Friday weekly together. Saturday's daily (24 Oct 4:00pm) falls just outside the 24h window.
- **Size:** about **$1.23B** notional (FXStreet, 22 Oct), roughly 14,800 BTC of contracts, with max pain near **$82,000**. That is small next to the **$11.2B** monthly on 30 Oct.
- **The expiry that matters:** the 30 Oct monthly, about 35% of Deribit BTC options OI, call-heavy (P/C ~0.52) with max pain at $79,000. It sits one day after the FOMC decision.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
23 Oct weekly	Max pain $82,000	~$1.23B total notional	Spot is just under max pain, so expiry pull is mildly upward. Too small to drive price alone.
23 Oct weekly	Puts at $80,000 (recurring weekly hedge)	Strike sizes not published	$80k is the main weekly put hedge; dealers long these puts buy dips into $80k, softening a break.
30 Oct monthly	$95,000 Call	25,570 BTC (~$2.08B)	Far out of the money; matters only on a big squeeze. Mostly decays toward zero.
30 Oct monthly	$70,000 Put	4,142 BTC (~$0.34B)	Deep downside hedge; becomes active only below ~$77k.

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm (daily + weekly)	~$1.23B	n/a	~$82,000	$80k puts key; strike sizes not published
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm (monthly)	~$11.2B	~0.52	$79,000	Calls $95k 25.6k BTC, $90k 15.2k, $100k 14.6k; Puts $70k 4.1k, $80k 2.8k, $72k 2.5k
Fri 25 Dec, 4:00pm (quarterly)	132,411 BTC (per CryptoTicker headline)	n/a	n/a	Year-end cluster; details not checked this run

30 Oct monthly - largest open interest by strike (BTC; USD at ~$81,300)



How options affect the market now

- **Weekly pin:** today's $1.23B expiry has max pain near $82,000, about $700 above spot. Expect a mild drift or chop toward $81.5k-82.5k into 4:00pm MYT, not a trend move.
- **$80k is the dealer floor:** $80k puts are the largest hedge on both the weekly and monthly. Dealers long those puts tend to buy dips near $80k, which slows a breakdown. A clean daily close below $80k removes that cushion and could speed selling toward $77k-79k.
- **Monthly gravity at $79k:** the 30 Oct max pain ($79,000) sits below spot. With the FOMC one day before settlement, the pull toward $79k-80k can grow next week.

- **Call wall is far:** the big call stack ($90k-$100k) is 10%+ above spot and mostly losing value. It caps sentiment, not price, unless BTC first reclaims $84k-$87k.
- **Sentiment:** monthly P/C ~0.52 is call-heavy, but traders paid up for puts (put skew ~16 vol points, IV 35-38% vs 25% realized on 21 Oct). Hedging demand is high and leverage is long-leaning.
- **After expiry:** the weekly roll-off frees some gamma. Volatility may pick up into the weekend and FOMC week.

Data note: the Deribit API and DVOL feed could not be read this run, so options figures come from published reports (FXStreet 22 Oct, CryptoTicker 10 and 17 Oct, Au79 21 Oct). Strike sizes are the largest seen in those reports, not a live snapshot; positions may have shifted. Implied daily move (~1.9%, ~$1,550) is estimated from the reported 35-38% IV, not a live DVOL reading.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC hit about $84,800-84,900 late Wed 21 Oct after a SpaceX-earnings tech bounce, then fell about 4% on Thu to an intraday low of ~$80,836. It is near $81,300 now.
- The drop was mostly long liquidations: $458M across crypto in 24h, 91% longs. BTC longs were $136M. The largest single order was an $11.8M BTC long on Binance near $83,500.
- $84,000-84,400 rejected again despite ~$1B of ETF inflows over three sessions. Buyers are absorbing supply, but they are not pushing price higher.
- BTC is trading like high-beta Nasdaq (20-day correlation ~0.78). Thursday's Nasdaq fell 2.6% on AI-capex fears (Meta -7%, Nvidia -4.4%).

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$84,000 - $84,400	Repeated rejection; ~ETF average cost basis $84,333; Bitfinex breakout trigger is a daily close above $84,400
Resistance 1	$82,500 - $83,500	Breakdown level from Thu, where the $11.8M long was liquidated; lower edge of the 19 Oct range
Pivot	$82,000	Weekly max pain into today's 4:00pm MYT expiry
Support	$80,000 - $81,250	Has caught every October flush; largest put hedge strike ($80k)
Deep risk	$77,000 - $79,000	Monthly max pain $79k; $77k trend-line invalidation; below that, Strategy cost basis $75,444

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Futures OI	~$37.8B (-2.2%, 22 Oct); 645k BTC on 20 Oct	Leverage trimmed, not fully reset
Funding	+0.0079%/8h (21 Oct); ~7-9% annualized	Mildly long-biased; no extreme
Liquidations 24h	$458M total (91% longs); BTC $141M	Long flush; dip may be partly cleaned out
Long/short (OKX accounts)	1.95 (from 1.21)	Retail buying the dip; risk of another flush
Spot BTC ETF flows	+$528M (21 Oct), +$23M (20 Oct), +$527M (19 Oct)	Strong demand; 22 Oct data pending
Options IV	~35-38% IV vs 25% realized; put skew ~16 vols (21 Oct)	Hedging is expensive; market braced for downside
Fear & Greed	68 Greed (22 Oct, pre-selloff)	Likely lower after Thursday's drop

4. News and macro

- **Oil shock:** Houthi strikes on Saudi targets, including near Aramco's Shaybah field, pushed Brent to ~$112, the highest since May. The US pulled some staff from the kingdom. Higher oil revives Fed rate-hike fears.
- **AI/tech sell-off:** Meta, Amazon, Nvidia, Lam Research and Micron fell on AI capex and financing worries. Nasdaq -2.6%, S&P -1.2%; China's CSI 300 entered a bear market.
- **Fed:** rates are 3.75-4.00%. The FOMC decision is Wed 28 Oct (Thu 29 Oct 2:00am MYT). A hot September CPI revived hike talk; US jobless claims fell to 194k.
- **Rates:** the US 10-year eased to ~5.04% on safe-haven buying; France's 10-year is above 5%. DXY is flat near 101.6; gold fell ~1.6% to ~$4,083.
- **Crypto:** Solana's Alpenglow upgrade went live but SOL still fell. The CLARITY Act is stalled since the 15 Sep Senate vote. The MSCI rule decision affecting Strategy is due 11 Nov.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit BTC weekly options expiry (~$1.23B, max pain ~$82k)
Thu 29 Oct, 2:00am	FOMC rate decision (2:30am press conference)
Thu 29 Oct, 8:30pm	US Q3 GDP advance + September PCE inflation
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit monthly expiry (~$11.2B, max pain $79k)
Wed 4 Nov (US 3 Nov)	US midterm elections
Fri 6 Nov, 9:30pm	US October jobs report (expected; confirm with BLS)
Wed 11 Nov	MSCI final index-rule list (Strategy exposure)

5. Summary and prediction

BTC gave back its Wednesday spike toward $85k. Macro is risk-off (oil above $110, AI-led tech sell-off, rate-hike fears into FOMC), and longs were flushed. ETF demand is still strong, but buyers are absorbing supply rather than lifting price. Options add a mild pull toward $82k into today's small weekly expiry. The bigger force is next week: the $11.2B monthly with max pain at $79k, one day after the Fed. The $80k-81.25k band, backed by the largest put hedges, is the line that decides whether this is a range or a leg lower. **24h call: choppy range $79,800-83,000, slight downside tilt; a close below $80k flips it bearish.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: range/pin	50%	$80,000 - $83,000	Drift toward $82k max pain into 4pm MYT expiry; Nasdaq stabilises; ETF inflows continue
Bearish: breakdown	30%	$77,000 - $80,000	Hourly/daily close below $80k; oil spikes again or Nasdaq drops further; ETF outflow print
Bullish: reclaim	20%	$83,000 - $85,000	Reclaim $82.5k-83.5k with strong ETF inflow (>$300M) and tech rebound; short squeeze toward $84.4k

- **Break down:** a 4h close below $80,000 means put protection is exhausted. Expect a fast move toward $79k max pain and $77k.
- **Break up:** holding above $83,500 after the 4pm MYT expiry, plus a positive 22 Oct ETF print, opens $84.4k. Only a daily close above $84,400 is a real breakout.
- Next report: 3:50pm MYT (Fri 23 Oct), just before the weekly expiry.

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